SUMMARY · MK 1 ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR & MANAGING PEOPLE · WEEK 3

Motivation at Work — Getting the Best Out of People

Why do some people perform well and others don't? This week answers via motivation: what it is, how it links to performance (AMO & MARS), and the main theories — Maslow, McClelland, Herzberg and Harvard's Four Drives — including whether money really motivates.

Material

1 What is motivation?

Motivation is **the desire to act and move toward a goal**. Campbell & Pritchard (1976) define it as factors explaining three aspects of effort: **direction** (where effort goes), **intensity** (how hard) and **persistence** (how long, especially when it's tough).

Because motivation is broad and fuzzy, it's best approached through **multiple theories**, each lighting a different angle.

2 Motivation and performance: Performance = Ability × Motivation

The basic formula: `Performance = f (Ability × Motivation)`

- **Ability** = aptitude + skill + task understanding.
- **Motivation** = three *choices*: to expend effort, how much ("is it worth it?"), and to persist.

Motivation is a **decision**, not a feeling. And because it's multiplication, if either is zero, performance is zero.

AMO (Lepak et al., 2006) adds **Opportunity**: performance needs Ability (can), Motivation (will) and Opportunity (allowed). HR systems work by strengthening all three.

MARS extends to Motivation, Ability, Role perceptions and Situational factors. If performance drops, don't conclude "lazy" — check all four.

> *"You cannot motivate someone; all you can do is provide a motivating environment and the players will motivate themselves." — Phil Jackson*

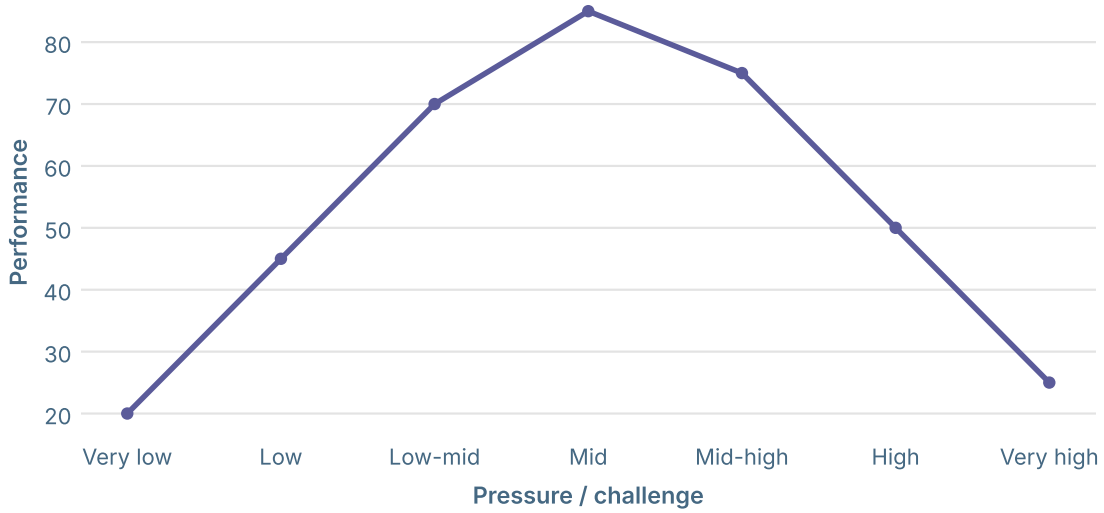
3 Try it: why motivation works as a multiplier

Deep dive

Performance = Ability × Motivation uses multiplication: zero motivation means zero performance.

	High motivation	Low motivation
High ability	Challenge, autonomy	Find the cause (recognition, fairness, meaning)
Low ability	Train, coach	Direct clearly, check role fit

Pressure vs performance (Yerkes–Dodson, conceptual)



Conceptual: moderate challenge maximises performance.

4 Four Drives theory (Nohria, Groysberg & Lee, 2008)

This HBR theory says people have four basic emotional drives; satisfaction peaks when **all four are met**.

Drive	Meaning	Note	Organizational lever
Acquire	Scarce goods: money, status, perks.	*Relative* — people compare.	Reward system tied to performance.
Bond	Belonging, being valued.	Can create *silos*.	Culture of collaboration and openness.
Comprehend	Meaningful, challenging work.	Want meaningful contribution.	Job design.
Defend	Security and justice.	Explains *resistance to change*.	Fair, transparent performance and resource processes.

The direct manager matters hugely — almost as much as company policy. Even with weak corporate policy, a manager can motivate their unit.

5 Classic theories: Maslow, McClelland, Herzberg

1. Maslow (1954): physiological → safety → social → esteem → self-actualization. Lower needs must be met first; self-actualization is never fully satisfied.

2. McClelland (1961): Achievement, Affiliation, Power — mixes differ by person; tailor tasks and rewards.

3. Herzberg (1959):

Hygiene (extrinsic)	Motivators (intrinsic)
Policies, supervision, salary, working conditions, job security	Advancement, development, recognition, responsibility, achievement

Bad → **dissatisfaction**; good → merely "no dissatisfaction".

Present → **satisfaction & motivation**.

The opposite of dissatisfaction is not satisfaction but *no dissatisfaction*. Raising pay stops complaints but doesn't automatically energize.

6 Motivation theories on one map

Deep dive



Hygiene

Pay, policy, supervision — prevent dissatisfaction.

vs

Motivators

Achievement, recognition, growth — create motivation.

Acquire

Fair rewards.

Bond

Culture.

Comprehend

Job design.

Defend

Transparent processes.

7 Does money really motivate? Intrinsic vs extrinsic

Cerasoli et al.'s (2014) 40-year meta-analysis: **money motivates — for certain kinds of work.** Intrinsic motivation is better for complex, creative tasks and predicts *quality*; extrinsic works for simple, repetitive tasks and drives *quantity*.

Crowding out: directly performance-tied incentives (commissions) can displace intrinsic motivation; indirect incentives (fair base pay, job stability) keep it strong.

Kerr (1995), "rewarding A while hoping for B": e.g. hoping for teamwork but paying individual bonuses; hoping for innovation but punishing failure. People do A.

Key takeaways

1. Motivation = direction, intensity, persistence of effort; it's a choice.
2. Performance = Ability × Motivation; AMO adds Opportunity, MARS adds Role perceptions & Situation.
3. Four Drives: acquire, bond, comprehend, defend — meet all four.
4. The direct manager strongly shapes team motivation.
5. Herzberg: hygiene prevents dissatisfaction; motivators create satisfaction.
6. Money works for simple/quantity tasks; intrinsic motivation for complex/quality tasks.
7. Beware "rewarding A while hoping for B".

Case studies

Case & worked answers

The Rudi and Kana case (IBCC, SBM-ITB)

Summary: Kana, an Assistant Manager in Product Development at a snack company, brought samples from Korea and helped test the "Kiddy Meal" recipe. When it impressed Mr. Sutanto, her boss Bram claimed project ownership. New MBA hires seem closer to the bosses. She wants to move to Nestlé/Danone; pay is IDR 4m + 1.5m transport while friends get cars; she supports three siblings and an ailing father. Her fiancé Rudi jokes and avoids conflict, hiding his own work stress. Kana feels the relationship going flat.

1. Problem: on the surface, anger at the boss; underneath, **collapsed motivation** from lack of recognition and perceived unfairness, financial pressure, and **ineffective Rudi–Kana communication**.

2. Why (using this week's theories): Herzberg — motivators lost (recognition, advancement), hygiene weak (supervision, relative pay). Four Drives — acquire (relative comparison), bond (lost friends), comprehend (feels like just "tasting at machines"), defend (injustice). McClelland — high nAch hurts most when unrecognized. AMO — opportunity blocked. Rudi behaves like a Steady type; well-meant but Kana needs serious support. Bram shows how the direct manager drives motivation up or down.

3. Advice: Kana — don't quit in anger; talk to Bram with facts, ask for a specific role; compare offers holistically. Rudi — listen seriously first, map options, share his own problems. Company — publicly credit the QA/PD team, include Kana in launch, fix recognition systems.

4. "Would you marry?" has no right answer — it shows work motivation spills into personal life, and that value fit and communication (Weeks 1–2) matter there too.

Worked examples

Problem 1 Easy **Kinerja = Kemampuan × Motivasi**

Skala 1–10. Andi: kemampuan 9, motivasi 3. Budi: kemampuan 6, motivasi 6. Siapa yang kinerjanya lebih tinggi, dan intervensi apa yang paling tepat untuk Andi?

1. Andi = 9 × 3 = 27. Budi = 6 × 6 = 36.
2. Karena hubungannya *perkalian*, faktor yang rendah menarik kinerja jauh ke bawah — kemampuan tinggi tidak bisa menutupi motivasi rendah.
3. Untuk Andi, pelatihan tambahan hampir tidak berguna (kemampuan sudah 9). Naikkan motivasi ke 6 → 9 × 6 = 54, kinerja hampir dua kali lipat.

Answer: Budi lebih tinggi (36 vs 27). Untuk Andi, fokus ke motivasi (penghargaan, tantangan, makna kerja), bukan pelatihan.

Practice questions

Try answering first. The answer key is below each question.

1. Highly skilled, almost zero motivation. By P = A × M, performance is...

A. Still high
B. Near zero
C. Half of max
D. Unaffected

Answer: B. Multiplication: one zero makes zero.

2. For Herzberg, pay is a...

A. Motivator
B. Hygiene factor
C. Need for achievement
D. Drive to comprehend

Answer: B. Bad pay dissatisfies; good pay alone doesn't motivate.

---

3. Kana feels her idea was taken. Which drive is hit hardest?

A. Acquire
B. Bond
C. Comprehend
D. Defend

Answer: D. Unfairness hits the drive to defend.

---

4. The organisational lever for the drive to comprehend is...

A. Reward system
B. Meaningful job design
C. Culture
D. Transparent processes

Answer: B. Comprehend = meaning and learning.

---

5. Performance usually peaks when pressure is...

A. Zero
B. Moderate
C. Very high
D. Irrelevant

Answer: B. Moderate challenge energises.

Sources

- Week 3 - Motivation at Work.pdf
- Week 3 - Motivation (Student Version) Rev 01.pdf
- Rudi dan Kana for Student.pdf